

PowerPoint Basics

Lesson 31 — Slides, Layouts, Masters and Views

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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What MS PowerPoint Is

- ▶ **MS PowerPoint** is the presentation program of the MS Office suite.
- ▶ A **presentation** is a file made of one or more pages; each page is called a **slide**.
- ▶ Slides are shown one after another as a **slide show** on screen or on a projector.
- ▶ The exam name is **Powerpoint Presentation**, and the usual short form is **PPT**.

The one idea

PowerPoint = slides shown in sequence; one slide is one screen of the show.

Full Forms and File Extensions

- ▶ **PPT** — PowerPoint Presentation; **PPTX** — PowerPoint XML Presentation (default since Office 2007).
- ▶ **PPSX** — PowerPoint Slide Show; **POTX** — PowerPoint Template; **PPTM** — macro-enabled presentation.
- ▶ Default working file: **.pptx**; template file: **.potx**; show file: **.ppsx**.
- ▶ Presentations can also be saved or exported as **.pdf**.

Trap alert

.pptx is the editable presentation; **.ppsx** opens directly as a slide show; **.potx** is the template.

Slide and Placeholder

- ▶ A **slide** is a single page of a presentation; it can hold text, pictures, charts, tables, audio, and video.
- ▶ A **placeholder** is the dotted-line box on a slide that holds such content (title, text, picture, chart, table).
- ▶ Click inside a placeholder and type, or use its icon to insert a picture, chart, or table.
- ▶ Placeholders come from the slide's **layout**; resizing or moving the placeholder changes only that slide.

Keep the pair straight

The slide is the page; the placeholder is the dotted box that holds content on that page.

Slide Layouts

- ▶ A **layout** is the arrangement of placeholders on a slide.
- ▶ Common layouts: Title Slide, Title and Content, Section Header, Two Content, Comparison, Blank.
- ▶ Apply or change a layout from Home tab → **Layout**; adding a new slide uses Home tab → **New Slide**.
- ▶ The **Blank** layout has no placeholders; content must be inserted manually.

Office desktop example

A class report uses Title Slide once, then Title and Content for every following point — same layout family, different content.

Themes vs Templates

Theme

- ▶ A coordinated set of colours, fonts, and effects.
- ▶ Applied from the Design tab; one click restyles all slides.

Template

- ▶ A ready-made pattern file (**.potx**) with a theme plus layouts and sample content.
- ▶ Starting from a template reuses its design for a new file.

A theme restyles; a template is a reusable starter file.

Slide Master and the Three Masters

- ▶ The **Slide Master** is the top-level slide that controls the design of all layouts and slides linked to it.
- ▶ Change the font, logo, or footer on the Slide Master and every linked slide follows.
- ▶ PowerPoint has three masters: **Slide Master**, **Handout Master**, and **Notes Master**.
- ▶ Open it from View tab → **Slide Master**; close with Close Master View.

Trap alert

Edit once on the Slide Master instead of fixing the same logo on forty separate slides.

Views at a Glance

View	Shows
Normal	Default editing view: slide pane + thumbnails + notes pane
Outline View	Text outline of all slides
Slide Sorter	Thumbnails of all slides; reorder and organise
Reading View	Full-screen-like reading without editing tools
Slide Show	Real full-screen show from a chosen slide
Notes Page	Slide above, speaker notes below

Normal is the default view; Slide Sorter manages order.

Normal View: the Default

- ▶ **Normal view** is the default editing view of PowerPoint.
- ▶ Three working areas: the large **slide pane**, the **slides/outline pane** (thumbnails on the left), and the **notes pane** below.
- ▶ All typing, formatting, and inserting happen here.
- ▶ Switch views from the View tab or the buttons on the status bar.

The one idea

If the question says “default editing view”, the answer is Normal view.

Slide Sorter and Reading Views

- ▶ **Slide Sorter** shows thumbnails of every slide together, so slides can be reordered by drag and drop.
- ▶ It is the best view for deleting, duplicating, or checking the whole order at a glance.
- ▶ **Reading View** shows the show almost full-screen for reading, with simple navigation, but without the editing tools.
- ▶ Reading View suits review on the author's own screen; Slide Show suits projection to an audience.

Notes Page and Speaker Notes

- ▶ **Notes** (speaker notes) are reminders typed in the notes pane below a slide; the audience never sees them during the show.
- ▶ **Notes Page view** shows one slide above its notes text, one page per slide.
- ▶ Notes print through File → Print → **Notes Pages**.
- ▶ During the show, notes are visible only in **Presenter View** on the speaker's screen.

Keep the pair straight

Notes help the speaker; handouts help the audience.

Handouts and Printing

- ▶ **Handouts** are printed sheets with several slides per page (1, 2, 3, 4, 6, or 9 slides).
- ▶ The common exam choice is **6 slides per page**; 3-per-page adds ruled lines for the audience to write on.
- ▶ Handout design is controlled by the **Handout Master**.
- ▶ Print path: File → Print; options include Full Page Slides, Handouts, Notes Pages, and Outline View.

Running the Slide Show

- ▶ **F5** starts the show from the beginning; **Shift+F5** starts from the current slide.
- ▶ Move forward with N, Space, Right arrow, or Enter; go back with P or Left arrow; end with **Esc**.
- ▶ Press **B** for a black screen and **W** for a white screen during the show.
- ▶ The Slide Show tab sets timing, rehearsal, and monitor options.

Trap alert

F5 = from the beginning; Shift+F5 = from the current slide. (WO 2026 Q80)

Transitions vs Animations

Transition

- ▶ Movement **between** slides (Fade, Push, Wipe, Morph).
- ▶ Set on the Transitions tab; one per slide.

Animation

- ▶ Movement of **objects on** a slide: Entrance, Emphasis, Exit, Motion Paths.
- ▶ Set on the Animations tab; managed in the Animation Pane.

Trap alert

Transition moves the slide; animation moves the object on the slide.

Trap Alert: PowerPoint Facts to Keep Straight

- ▶ **.pptx** = editable presentation; **.ppsx** = show file; **.potx** = template.
- ▶ Slide Master controls all linked slides; Handout and Notes Masters control print layouts.
- ▶ **Normal** is the default view; **Slide Sorter** reorders.
- ▶ Notes are for the **speaker**; handouts are for the **audience**.
- ▶ F5 starts from the **beginning**; Shift+F5 from the **current** slide.

Lesson 31: Recall

- ▶ Presentation = ordered slides; each slide holds placeholders placed by its layout.
- ▶ Theme = colours, fonts, effects; template = reusable starter file (.potx); Slide Master controls all linked slides.
- ▶ Views: Normal (default editing), Slide Sorter (reorder), Reading (review), Notes Page (speaker notes), Slide Show (present).
- ▶ Notes help the speaker; handouts (1–9 per page) help the audience; print via File → Print.
- ▶ F5 from the beginning, Shift+F5 from the current slide; transitions move between slides, animations move objects on a slide.